

Silent Night, Holy Night

Text: Joseph Mohr, 1818;
tr. John Freeman Young, 1863
STILLE NACHT irregular

Music: Franz Gruber, 1818

The musical score is written for a four-part vocal choir (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) and piano accompaniment. It is in the key of D major (indicated by two sharps) and 6/8 time. The score is divided into three systems. The first system contains the first four lines of the hymn, with a key signature change to D major (F#) for the second line. The second system contains the next four lines, with a key signature change to D major (F#) for the second line. The third system contains the final four lines, with a key signature change to D major (F#) for the second line. The piano accompaniment is written in the bass clef and provides a harmonic foundation for the vocal parts. The lyrics are in English and are written below the vocal staves. The score is irregular, meaning it does not follow a standard 4-measure phrase structure.

System 1: Key signature: D major (F#). Chords: B, F#, B.

1 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! All is calm, all is bright,
2 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Shep - herds quake at the sight,
3 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Son of God, love's pure light,
4 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Won - drous star, lend thy light,

System 2: Key signature: D major (F#). Chords: E, B, E, B.

round yon vir - gin moth - er and child, ho - ly In - fant, so ten - der and mild,
glo - ries stream from heav - en a - far, heav'n - ly hosts sing: "Al - le - lu - ia,
ra - diant beams from Thy ho - ly face, with the dawn of re - deem - ing grace,
with the an - gels let us sing, Al - le - lu - ia to our King,

System 3: Key signature: D major (F#). Chords: F#, B, F#, B.

sleep in heav - en - ly peace, sleep in heav - en - ly peace.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born."
Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born.